

Class Notes: Phylum Ctenophora

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Key Organisation Features

Commonly known as sea walnuts, comb jellies or sea gooseberries; exclusively marine, radially symmetrical, diploblastic, tissue level of organisation. Digestion is extracellular or intracellular; locomotion is by eight rows of externally located ciliated comb plates.

Comb Plates, Colloblasts and Reproduction

Sexes are not separate (hermaphrodite); reproduction is sexual only with external fertilisation and indirect development (cydippid larva).

Examples

Exhibit bioluminescence — the ability to emit light. Examples: Pleurobrachia (sea gooseberry) and Ctenoplana (sea walnut).